

Lemurs



There are more than 100 species of lemur, and all of them are found only on the island of Madagascar and nowhere else. The five ranges on this map represent a small sample of these isolated primates, and they all heavily depend on their forest habitats for survival.

50 SILKY SIFAKAS ARE LEFT IN THE WILD—THEY ARE ONE OF THE RAREST PRIMATES IN THE WORLD



Spiny tree habitat

Thorny forests in the dry south of Madagascar—where spiny trees grow like giant cacti—are home to particular kinds of lemurs, such as Verreaux's sifaka. They have padded palms and soles on their hands and feet, allowing them to leap from trunk to trunk without injury.

Verreaux's sifaka

The powerful thighs of a sifaka—good for leaping from tree to tree—are also used for bounding across the ground or along horizontal branches. They live in forest habitats, including tropical rainforest and spiny dry forest.

Red-tailed sportive lemur

Despite its name, this species is not very active. Restricted to a tiny area of dry deciduous forest between two rivers, individuals rarely travel more than $\frac{3}{8}$ mile (1 km) from their home range. When their habitats are deforested, they are unlikely to move to distant trees.

Fat-tailed dwarf lemur

This dwarf lemur endures Madagascar's dry winter season by entering a hibernation-like state and surviving on the stores of fat in its tail. Though its range is small, it is one of the few lemur species with an abundant population.

Ring-tailed lemur

The ring-tailed lemur is found only in Madagascar's dry southern forests and arid open areas. It spends 70 percent of its time on the ground, more than any other lemur species.

ANIMALS IN DANGER

▲ IUCN lists 34 lemur species as critically endangered, including the red-tailed sportive lemur and Verreaux's sifaka, and 45 as endangered, including the ring-tailed lemur and aye-aye. Most others are vulnerable.